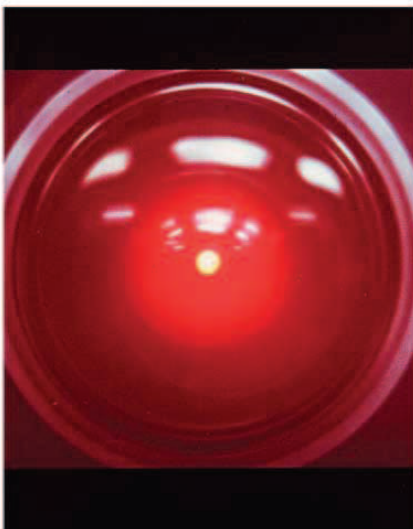




I'M SORRY, DAVE. I'M AFRAID I CAN'T DO THAT

2001: A SPACE ODYSSEY / 1968

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Science fiction

DIRECTOR

Stanley Kubrick

WRITERS

Arthur C. Clarke,
Stanley Kubrick

STARS

Keir Dullea, Gary
Lockwood, William
Sylvester, Douglas Rain

BEFORE

1964 *Dr. Strangelove*, Kubrick's Cold War black comedy, shows man's self-destructive nature.

1968 Franklin J. Schaffner's *Planet of the Apes* sends an astronaut (Charlton Heston) into the future.

AFTER

1971 *A Clockwork Orange* is Kubrick's darkly comic vision of a near-future dystopia.

1984 *1010*, Peter Hyams' sequel to *2001*, returns to the mystery of the Monoliths.



All science fiction is about the unknown, but few movies have embraced it as fully as *2001: A Space Odyssey*, Stanley Kubrick's journey to the dark side of the solar system. While he and cowriter Arthur C. Clarke draw on familiar science-fiction story elements—the dangerous mission, the homicidal supercomputer, humanity's first contact with alien intelligence—Kubrick arranges them in an unfamiliar way to give audiences something unique and unforgettably strange.

Completed a year before the first Moon landing and 30 years before a chess computer beat the world champion, Kubrick's space-age vision remains extraordinarily compelling.

The movie is loosely structured around a series of turning points in human evolution, but despite the grandiose five-note fanfare of Richard Strauss's *Thus Spake Zarathustra*—the movie's famous musical motif—these moments are not epiphanies. They only serve to deepen the mystery of humankind's

“Its origin and purpose are still a total mystery.”

Mission Control's last words / *2001: A Space Odyssey*